

The history of tea - Shunan Teng

TED-Ed

중국 황제부터 전 세계로, 차(茶)의 흥미로운 역사

Intermediate

4:58

DURATION

155

WPM

62

SEGMENTS

20

VOCABULARY

10

GRAMMAR



[10-Step Study →](#)

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01 Video Structure Overview

This 4-minute video by TED-Ed is structured into 8 key sections.

1 intro

0:06 ~ 0:28

신농씨의 신화를 통해 차의 전설적인 기원을 소개해요. 독에 중독된 후 우연히 차를 발견한 이야기로 청중의 흥미를 끌어요.

Shen Nong, the divine farmer, was poisoned 72 times

A tea leaf accidentally revived him

This is an ancient legend, not historical fact

2 body

0:28 ~ 0:58

전설에서 고고학적 증거로 전환하며, 차가 6,000년 전 중국에서 재배되었고 원래는 음료가 아닌 음식으로 소비되었다고 설명해요.

Tea cultivation dates back 6,000 years in China

This predates the Great Pyramids by 1,500 years

Tea was originally eaten as a vegetable or with porridge

3 body

0:58 ~ 1:41

1,500년 전에 차가 음식에서 음료로 바뀌었어요. 준비 방법이 말차로 발전했고, 차가 예술과 시, 황제의 총애의 대상이 되면서 풍부한 중국 차 문화가 형성되었어요.

Heat and moisture unlocked complex flavors from tea leaves

Matcha became the standard preparation method

Tea culture included art, poetry, and foam art similar to modern latte art

4 body

1:42 ~ 2:26

9세기에 차가 일본에 전해져 다도가 탄생했어요. 명나라 때 잎차가 떡차를 대체했고, 중국은 차 독점권을 유지했으며, 1600년대에 네덜란드 상인들이 차를 유럽에 가져왔어요.

A Japanese monk brought tea to Japan during the Tang Dynasty

The Ming Dynasty shifted from cake tea to loose leaf tea

China held a monopoly on tea alongside porcelain and silk

Dutch traders brought tea to Europe in large quantities

5 body

2:26 ~ 3:08

차가 유럽, 특히 영국에서 엄청난 인기를 끌었어요. 높은 가격과 중국의 독점이 치열한 경쟁을 부추겨 클리퍼선이 탄생하고 거대한 글로벌 무역이 형성되었어요.

Queen Catherine of Braganza popularized tea in English aristocracy

Britain's colonial expansion spread tea culture globally

Tea sold for 10 times the price of coffee in 1700

Clipper Ships were built to race tea to Europe

6 body

3:08 ~ 3:50

영국의 차 무역은 중국과의 파괴적인 아편 전쟁으로 이어졌어요. 영국이 차 대신 아편을 교역하면서 중독과 분쟁이 발생했고, 패배한 청나라는 홍콩을 할양하며 1세기 이상 약화되었어요.

Britain traded opium for Chinese tea when silver became too expensive

Opium caused a public health crisis in China

The first Opium War (1839-1842) resulted in China ceding Hong Kong

The war weakened China's global standing for over a century

7 body

3:51 ~ 4:20

영국 동인도 회사가 로버트 포춘을 비밀 작전에 보내 중국에서 차나무와 기술을 훔쳐왔어요. 인도 다르질링으로 밀반출하며 중국의 독점을 깨고 차의 세계적 확산을 이끌었어요.

Robert Fortune disguised himself and infiltrated China's tea regions

He smuggled tea plants and workers to Darjeeling, India

This broke China's monopoly and made tea an everyday commodity worldwide

8 conclusion

4:20 ~ 4:57

오늘날 차는 물 다음으로 세계에서 두 번째로 많이 소비되는 음료이며, 전 세계 문화마다 놀라울 정도로 다양한 준비 방법이 있어요.

Tea is the second most consumed beverage in the world

Preparation styles range from sugary Turkish tea to salty Tibetan butter tea

There are nearly as many tea traditions as there are cultures

02 Essential Vocabulary

Core words from the video that are high-value for learners.

edible /'ɛdɪbl/ adjective

safe or suitable to be eaten

먹을 수 있는, 식용의

Latin 'edibilis' from 'edere' meaning 'to eat'

ed (eat)

-ible

"During a long day spent roaming the forest in search of edible grains and herbs."

Related: eat, inedible, edibility

weary /'wɪəri/ adjective

feeling or showing extreme tiredness, especially from excessive effort

지친, 피곤한, 싫증 난

Old English 'wērig' meaning 'tired, exhausted'

wear (tire)

-y

"The weary divine farmer Shen Nong accidentally poisoned himself 72 times."

Related: weariness, wearisome, tired

mythical /'mɪθɪkəl/ adjective

occurring in or characteristic of myths or folk tales; imaginary or fictitious

신화의, 신화적인, 상상 속의

Greek 'mythos' meaning 'story, tale' + '-ical'

myth (story)

-ical

"The mythical Chinese inventor of agriculture, highlights tea's importance to ancient China."

Related: myth, mythology, mythological

archaeological /ˌɑːrkiə'lɒdʒɪkəl/ adjective

relating to the study of human history through excavation of sites and analysis of artifacts

고고학의, 고고학적인

Greek 'arkhaios' (ancient) + 'logos' (study)

archaeo-

log (study)

-ical

"Archaeological evidence suggests tea was first cultivated there as early as 6,000 years ago."

Related: archaeology, archaeologist, archaic

cultivated /ˈkʌltɪveɪtɪd/ verb (past participle)

prepared and used land for growing crops; developed or improved through care

재배된, 경작된, 교양 있는

Latin 'cultivare' meaning 'to till, tend'

cultiv (till, grow)

-ated

"Tea was first cultivated there as early as 6,000 years ago."

Related: cultivate, cultivation, culture

moisture /ˈmɔɪstʃər/ noun

water or other liquid diffused in a small quantity; dampness

수분, 습기

Old French 'moistour' from 'moiste' meaning 'damp'

moist (damp)

-ure

"When people realized that a combination of heat and moisture could create a complex and varied taste."

Related: moist, moisten, moisturize

extravagant /ɪkˈstrævəɡənt/ adjective

exceeding what is reasonable or appropriate; elaborate and impressive

사치스러운, 화려한, 과도한

Latin 'extra-' (outside) + 'vagari' (to wander)

extra-

vag (wander)

-ant

"They would draw extravagant pictures in the foam of the tea."

Related: extravagance, vagrant, vagabond

ritual /ˈrɪtʃuəl/ noun

a ceremony or series of acts regularly repeated in a set manner

의식, 의례, 관례

Latin 'ritualis' from 'ritus' meaning 'religious ceremony'

rit (ceremony)

-ual

"The Japanese eventually developed their own unique rituals around tea."

Related: rite, ritualistic, ceremony

monopoly /məˈnɒpəli/ noun

the exclusive possession or control of the supply of a commodity or service

독점, 독점권, 전매

Greek 'monos' (single) + 'polein' (to sell)

mono-

poly (sell)

"China still held a virtual monopoly on the world's tea trees."

Related: monopolize, monopolistic, oligopoly

aristocracy /ˌæɪrɪˈstɒkrəsi/ noun

the highest class in certain societies, typically comprising people of noble birth

귀족, 귀족 계급, 상류층

Greek 'aristokratia' from 'aristos' (best) + 'kratos' (power, rule)

aristo (best) + crat (rule)

-y

"For making tea popular with the English aristocracy when she married King Charles II in 1661."

Related: aristocrat, aristocratic, democratic

colonial /kəˈlɒniəl/ adjective

relating to or characteristic of a colony or colonialism

식민지의, 식민지 시대의

Latin 'colonus' meaning 'farmer, settler' from 'colere' (to cultivate)

colon (settle, cultivate)

-ial

"Great Britain was in the midst of expanding its colonial influence."

Related: colony, colonist, colonize

lucrative /ˈluːkrətɪv/ adjective

producing a great deal of profit; very profitable

수익성이 좋은, 돈벌이가 되는

Latin 'lucratus' from 'lucrari' meaning 'to gain profit'

lucr (profit, gain)

-ative

"The tea trade was so lucrative that the world's fastest sailboat, the Clipper Ship, was born."

Related: lucre, profitable, gainful

opium /'ɒpiəm/ noun

a highly addictive narcotic drug obtained from the juice of the opium poppy

아편

Greek 'opion' meaning 'poppy juice' from 'opos' (vegetable juice)

opi (juice/poppy)

-um

"They suggested trading tea for another substance, opium."

Related: opiate, opioid, narcotic

addicted /ə'dɪktɪd/ adjective

physically and mentally dependent on a particular substance or activity

중독된, 빠져 있는

Latin 'addictus' meaning 'assigned, devoted' from 'addicere' (to devote)

ad-

dict (say, assign)

-ed

"This triggered a public health problem within China, as people became addicted to the drug."

Related: addiction, addictive, addict

ceded /'siː dɪd/ verb (past tense)

gave up power, territory, or rights, especially by treaty

할양한, 양도한

Latin 'cedere' meaning 'to go, yield, give way'

ced (go, yield)

-ed

"The defeated Qing Dynasty ceded the port of Hong Kong to the British."

Related: cede, concede, precede, secede

commissioned /kə'mɪʃənd/ verb (past tense)

ordered or authorized the production of something; gave an official task

위임한, 의뢰한, 임명한

Latin 'commissio' from 'committere' meaning 'to entrust'

com-

miss (send)

-ioned

"They commissioned botanist Robert Fortune to steal tea from China in a covert operation."

Related: commission, missionary, mission

perilous /ˈpɛrɪləs/ adjective

full of danger or risk; hazardous

위험한, 위태로운

Latin 'periculosus' from 'periculum' meaning 'danger, risk'

peril (danger)

-ous

"He disguised himself and took a perilous journey through China's mountainous tea regions."

Related: peril, imperil, hazardous

commodity /kəˈmɒdɪti/ noun

a raw material or primary agricultural product that can be bought and sold

상품, 물자, 원자재

Latin 'commoditas' meaning 'fitness, convenience' from 'commodus' (convenient)

com-

mod (measure, manner)

-ity

"Helping drive tea's rapid growth as an everyday commodity."

Related: commodities, accommodate, mode

03 Additional Vocabulary

Supplementary words that appear in the video and are useful for expanding your vocabulary.

porridge /'pɒrɪdʒ/ noun

a soft food made by boiling grain or cereal in water or milk

죽, 포리지

Middle English alteration of 'pottage' meaning 'soup, stew'

porr (pot/cook)

-idge

"It was eaten as a vegetable or cooked with grain porridge."

Related: pottage, oatmeal, gruel

porcelain /'pɔːrsəlɪn/ noun

a hard, white, translucent ceramic material used for making fine pottery

도자기, 자기

Italian 'porcellana' from 'porcella' (cowrie shell), due to its resemblance

porcell (shell-like)

-ain

"Making tea one of three essential Chinese export goods, along with porcelain and silk."

Related: ceramic, pottery, china

04 Grammar Patterns

Key grammar structures used in the video. Each pattern includes real examples.

Past participle phrase as modifier (spent + V-ing)

A past participle phrase modifies a noun, adding descriptive information. 'Spent roaming' describes how the day was occupied.

과거분사구가 명사를 수식하며 추가 정보를 제공합니다. 'spent roaming'은 하루를 어떻게 보냈는지 설명하는 구조로, '~하며 보낸'이라고 해석해요.

During a long day spent roaming the forest in search of edible grains and herbs.

Before + subject + could + verb (temporal clause)

Used to describe an action that almost happened but was prevented. It creates suspense by showing what nearly occurred before an interruption.

'before + 주어 + could + 동사'는 어떤 일이 일어나기 직전에 다른 일이 개입했음을 나타내요. '~하기 전에'라는 의미로 긴장감을 만들어요.

But before the poisons could end his life, a leaf drifted into his mouth.

As early as + time expression

Used to emphasize that something happened surprisingly long ago. It highlights the ancient or early nature of an event.

'as early as + 시간 표현'은 어떤 일이 놀라울 정도로 오래전에 일어났음을 강조할 때 사용해요. '무려 ~이나 이른 시기에'라는 의미예요.

Tea was first cultivated there as early as 6,000 years ago.

Or 1,500 years before the pharaohs built the Great Pyramids of Giza.

Passive voice: was/were + past participle

Used when the focus is on the action or result rather than the doer. Common in historical narratives and academic descriptions.

수동태(be동사 + 과거분사)는 행위자보다 행동이나 결과에 초점을 맞출 때 사용해요. 역사 서술과 학술적 설명에서 자주 쓰이며, '~되었다'로 해석해요.

It was eaten as a vegetable or cooked with grain porridge.

Tea was the subject of books and poetry.

Would + verb (past habitual / narrative future)

Used in narratives to describe repeated actions in the past or to indicate future events from a past perspective.

'would + 동사원형'은 과거의 반복적 행동을 서술하거나, 과거 시점에서 미래를 이야기할 때 사용해요. '~하곤 했다' 또는 '~하게 될 것이었다'라는 의미예요.

They would draw extravagant pictures in the foam of the tea.

Leading to + noun (result clause with present participle)

A participial phrase that indicates a result or consequence of a previous action. It smoothly connects cause and effect.

'leading to + 명사'는 이전 행동의 결과나 귀결을 나타내는 분사구예요. 원인과 결과를 자연스럽게 연결하며, '~으로 이어졌다'라는 의미예요.

Leading to the creation of the Japanese tea ceremony.

So + adjective + that + clause (result clause)

Used to express cause and effect: the degree of something is so great that it produces a specific result.

'so + 형용사/부사 + that + 절'은 정도가 너무 커서 특정 결과를 초래함을 표현해요. '너무 ~해서 ...하다'라는 의미의 인과관계 구조예요.

The tea trade was so lucrative that the world's fastest sailboat, the Clipper Ship, was born.

Matcha became so popular that a distinct Chinese tea culture emerged.

When + clause (temporal transition in narrative)

Used to indicate the specific time or condition under which an event occurred. It is a key structure for organizing chronological narratives.

'when + 절'은 특정 사건이 발생한 시점이나 조건을 나타내요. 시간 순서에 따른 서술을 정리하는 핵심 구조로, '~했을 때'라는 의미예요.

When that proved too expensive, they suggested trading tea for another substance.

When the defeated Qing Dynasty ceded the port of Hong Kong to the British.

Present participle phrase as adverbial (helping drive...)

A present participle phrase used to add information about how or why something happened, functioning as an adverbial modifier.

현재분사구가 부사적으로 쓰여 어떤 일이 어떻게 또는 왜 일어났는지 부가 설명을 해요. '~하면서, ~하여'라는 의미로 간결하게 정보를 덧붙여요.

Helping drive tea's rapid growth as an everyday commodity.

Making tea one of three essential Chinese export goods.

From A to B (range/contrast structure)

Used to show the full range or variety of something by presenting two contrasting extremes. It emphasizes diversity.

'from A to B'는 두 가지 대조적인 극단을 제시하여 범위나 다양성을 보여주는 구조예요. 'A에서 B까지'라는 의미로 다양성을 강조해요.

And from sugary Turkish Riza tea to salty Tibetan butter tea.

05 Connected Speech & Pronunciation

Natural pronunciation patterns found in the talk. Practice these to sound more natural!

Linking (연음)

search of edible → **서처베디블** /sɜːrtʃ_əv_ˈedɪbl/
'search'의 마지막 소리가 약화된 'of'(/əv/)와 연결되고, /v/가 'edible'의 첫 모음 /
ɛ/과 이어져 세 단어가 매끄럽게 연결돼요.
'서치 오브 에디블'이 아니라 '서처베디블'처럼 끊지 않고 연결해서 발음해 보세요.

spread around → **스프레더라운드** /sprɛd_əˈraʊnd/
'spread'의 마지막 /d/가 'around'의 첫 소리 /ə/와 부드럽게 연결돼요. 자음-
모음 연결이 두 단어를 하나처럼 흐르게 해요.
'스프레드 어라운드'로 끊지 말고 '스프레더라운드'처럼 /d/와 /ə/를 이어서 발
음해 보세요.

smuggling tea trees and experienced → **스머글링 티 트리전덱스피어리 언스트**
/ˈsmʌɡlɪŋ tiː triː z_ənd_ɪk ˈspɪəriənst/
'trees'의 /z/가 약화된 'and'와 연결되고,
'and'의 /d/가 'experienced'의 /ɪ/와 이어져 매끄러운 소리 연쇄가 만들어져요.
'트리즈 앤드 익스피어리언스트'가 아니라 연결되는 부분을 끊지 않고 '트리전덱스피어리언스트'처럼 이어서 발음해 보세요.

Reduction (축약)

poisoned himself → **포이즌딤셀프** /ˈpɔɪznd_ɪmˈself/
'himself'의 /h/가 연결 발화에서 탈락하고, 'poisoned'의 /d/가 바로 /ɪ/와 연결돼요. 대명사에서 /h/ 탈락은 매우 흔한 현상이에요.
'포이즌드 힘셀프'가 아니라 '포이즌딤셀프'처럼 /h/를 생략하고 바로 이어서 발음해 보세요.

combination of heat and → **컴비네이션 오브 히트**

/ˌkɒmbɪˈneɪʃən_əv_hiː t_ən/

'of'와 'and' 모두 크게 축약돼요. 'of'는 /ə/로, 'and'는 /ən/ 또는 /n/으로 줄어들어요. 기능어는 자연스러운 발화에서 일상적으로 약화돼요.

'컴비네이션 오브 히트 앤드'가 아니라 'of'를 /어/로, 'and'를 /은/으로 가볍게 발음해 보세요.

Elision (탈락)

chewed on it → **추도닛**

/tʃuː d_ɒnɪt/

'chewed'의 /d/가 'on' 앞에서 부드러워지고, 'on'의 /n/이 'it'의 /ɪ/와 연결되어 세 단어가 하나의 덩어리처럼 들려요.

'츄드 온 잇'이 아니라 '추도닛'처럼 자연스럽게 이어 발음해 보세요.

first opium war → **퍼스 오피엄 워**

/fɜː s 'ɒpiəm wɔː r/

'first'의 마지막 /t/가 'opium'의 /oʊ/ 앞에서 탈락해요. /st/ 자음군 뒤에 다른 단어가 오면 마지막 /t/가 흔히 생략돼요.

'퍼스트 오피엄'에서 /t/를 뚜렷이 발음하지 말고, '퍼스 오피엄'처럼 /t/를 생략해 보세요.

Assimilation (동화)

in earnest → **이너니스트**

/ɪ'nɜː rɪnst/

'in'의 /n/이 'earnest'의 첫 모음 /ɜː/와 합쳐져 비음인 모음으로 자연스럽게 흘러가며, 두 단어가 하나의 단어처럼 들려요.

'인 어니스트'로 끊지 말고 '이너니스트'처럼 /n/과 /ɜː/를 이어서 발음해 보세요.

06 Signal Expressions

Key phrases used to structure the content. Learning these helps you follow presentations.

EMPHASIS

"During a long day spent roaming the forest"

서사적 묘사로 시작하여 이야기 속으로 청중을 끌어들이는 도입부예요

SUMMARY

"And that is how we discovered tea"

전설의 핵심을 요약하며 이야기의 첫 번째 단락을 마무리해요

TRANSITION

"Or so an ancient legend goes, at least"

전설에서 사실적 서술로 전환하며, 이야기의 신뢰성에 대한 여지를 남겨요

TRANSITION

"Archaeological evidence suggests"

신화에서 과학적 증거로 전환하며 역사적 서술을 시작해요

TRANSITION

"Tea only shifted from food to drink 1,500 years ago"

차의 용도 변화라는 중요한 전환점을 알리며 새로운 시대로 넘어가요

TRANSITION

"In the 9th century, during the Tang Dynasty"

구체적인 시대와 왕조를 제시하며 일본으로의 차 전파 이야기를 시작해요

TRANSITION

"That spread began in earnest around the early 1600s"

차의 세계적 확산이 본격화된 시점을 알리며 유럽 진출 이야기로 전환해요

TRANSITION

"At first, Britain paid for all this Chinese tea with silver"

무역 방식의 변화를 소개하며 아편 전쟁으로 이어지는 서술을 시작해요

EMPHASIS

"This act triggered the first opium war"

인과관계를 명확히 하며 전쟁이라는 중대한 사건의 시작을 강조해요

TRANSITION

"The British East India Company also wanted"

'also'를 통해 추가적인 영국의 행동을 소개하며 로버트 포춘의 이야기로 전환해요

TRANSITION

"Today, tea is the second most consumed beverage"

과거 서술에서 현재로 돌아오며 결론부로 전환해요

Keep Learning!

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